

Leonard le Roux

Email: leonard.leroux@sciencespo.fr
Website: <https://leonardleroux.github.io/>
[Google Scholar](#)

Current Appointment

World Bank Group - Postdoctoral researcher, Development Economics Private Markets Department (DECPM)
(July 2025-)

Education

Ph.D. Sciences Po, 2025
Economics

M.Com. University of Cape Town, 2019
Economics, Specialising in Applied Economics, with distinction in the dissertation.

M.A. CERDI, University of Clermont Auvergne, 2017
Development Economics, with distinction (mention: Très Bien)

B.Com. Honours, Stellenbosch University, 2016
Economics

B.Soc.Sci., University of Cape Town, 2015
Mathematics, Economics, Philosophy (triple major)

Publications

1. Visser, M., Le Roux, L., Mulwa, C., Tibesigwa, B., and Ayele, M. (2024), "[Adaptive Investment With Land Tenure and Weather Risk: Behavioral Evidence From Tanzania](#)", Journal of Economic Behaviour and Organization, Vol. 217, pp. 398-433.
2. Le Roux, L., and Choumert-Nkolo, J. (2024), "[Leaving the Hearth You Know: Internal Migration and Energy Poverty](#)", World Development.
3. Das, I., Le Roux, L., Jeuland, M., and Ruhinduka, R. (2024), "[Willingness to Pay for Cooking Fuels in Two African Cities: A Comparative Analysis of Nairobi and Dar es Salaam](#)", PLOS Sustainability and Transformation.
4. Bruhl, J.M., Le Roux, L., Visser, M., and Kohlin, G. (2020), "[Decision-Making in a Water Crisis: Lessons From the Cape Town Drought for Urban Water Policy](#)", Oxford Encyclopedia of Water Resources Management and Policy. (book chapter)
5. Choumert-Nkolo, J., Combes Motel, P., and Le Roux, L. (2019), "[Stacking up the Ladder: A Panel Data Analysis of Tanzanian Household Energy Choices](#)", World Development, Vol. 115, pp. 222-235.

Working Papers

1. Individual Agglomeration Gains and Sorting in South Africa
(*R&R at Regional Science and Urban Economics*)

2. Cooperative Governance: Traditional Leaders and Local Government (with Dieter von Fintel)
(Submitted)
3. Informality and Violence: Evidence from South Africa (Job Market Paper)
4. The Political Economy of Migration Restrictions under Apartheid (with Tomás Domínguez-Iino)

Experience

Royal Economic Society

Replicator, the Economic Journal (part time), 2023

Environmental Economics Policy Research Unit (EPRU)

Junior Research Fellow, Environment for Development Initiative (EfD), 2018–2020

Centre d'Etudes et de Recherches sur le Développement International (CERDI)

Research Intern, 2017

University of Cape Town, School of Economics

Research Assistant and Tutor, 2016–2017

Numeric

Mathematics Coach, 2015

Grants & Awards

Aix-Marseille School of Economics PhD fellowship, 2024-25

UNU-Wider research grant, 2023

Center for History and Economics in Paris PhD student grant, 2022-2023

Oppenheimer Memorial Trust Doctoral Scholarship, 2020-2023

UNU-Wider research grant, 2020

Sciences Po Department of Economics Doctoral Contract, 2020-2023

National Research Foundation Masters scholarship, 2018

Embassy of France in South Africa Masters Scholarship, 2016-2017

University of Cape Town travel fund grant, 2013

Academic Presentations

2026. International Industrial Organization Conference (IIOC), City St George's and CMA Annual Workshop in Economics of Competition and Regulation, Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona, World Bank DECPM Brown Bag Lunch

2025. LEAP Bocconi (virtual), Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona, CERDI Université Clermont Auvergne, ENS de Lyon, World Bank-IGC 9th Urbanization and Development Conference

2024. CSAE conference, Oxford; European Meeting of the Urban Economics Association; HEC PhD conference; International Conference on Development Economics

2023. Warwick PhD student conference; UNU-Wider work-in-progress workshop; IAST-OxPo conference; CSAE, Oxford; Transport, Energy and Climate Economics Working Group, Dauphine PSL; Sciences Po Department of Economics Departmental Seminar

2022. Sciences Po Department of Economics Departmental Seminar; Stellenbosch University Spatial Economics Workshop; NOVAFRICA Conference on Economic Development

2021. Sciences Po Department of Economics Seminar; Economic History of Developing Regions Virtual Seminar; Environment for Development Annual Meeting

2019. Stellenbosch University Spatial Econometrics Workshop, Stellenbosch; Sustainable Energy Transitions Initiative (SETI) annual meeting, Santiago; Future of Farmworkers conference, Cape Town

2018. Sustainable Energy Transitions Initiative (SETI) annual meeting, Duke University; Asian Development Bank Market-Based Approaches to Environmental Management, Manila, Philippines (participant)

Teaching

Quantitative Methods - Fall 2021 (Sciences Po). Developer of course material and course instructor.

Labour Economics - Spring 2021 (Sciences Po). Teaching assistant to Pierre Cahuc.

Development Economics - Fall 2021 (Sciences Po). Teaching assistant to Golvine de Rochambeau.

Economic History - Fall 2022 (Sciences Po). Teaching assistant to Moritz Schularick.

Developing and Emerging Economies - Fall 2021 (Sciences Po). Teaching assistant to Jerome Sgard.

Contributions to policy reports

[Greening Markets: Market Based Approaches for Environmental Management In Asia](#), 2021. Asian Development Bank. (Contributing member of research team, not an author.)

Refereeing

World Development; Journal of Law, Economics and Organization; American Journal of Agricultural Economics

Statistical programming skills

R, Stata, Qgis, familiarity with version control using Git.

Language Skills

English (fluent), Afrikaans (fluent), French (fluent), Spanish (intermediate)

Campus Activities

Co-organiser of PhD Seminar series, Sciences Po, 2022-2023

Executive committee member, University of Cape Town Mountain and Ski Club, 2012-2014

Executive committee member, University of Cape Town Student Sports Union, 2016-2017

Citizenship

South African

References

Professor Benjamin Marx
Boston University, Department of Economics
617-353-4123, bmarx@bu.edu

Professor Pierre-Philippe Combes
Sciences Po Paris, Department of Economics
+33145495050, pierrephilippe.combes@sciencespo.fr

Professor Roberto Galbiati
Sciences Po Paris, Department of Economics
+33145495050, roberto.galbiati@sciencespo.fr

Professor Gunnar Kohlin
Gothenburg University, Department of Economics
+46317864426, gunnar.kohlin@efd.gu.se

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<https://leonardleroux.github.io/>